

Merchandise Listing

Metadata:

- **Question:** Merchandise Listing
- **Specialization:** Backend
- **Competency:** D&A
- **Level:** L4, L5A, L5B

Interviewer Guidance: Use the framework below to guide the conversation...

Question: Design a backend system for an e-commerce website that shows a list of merchandise. The system should focus on the browsing aspect, **not on how to make** purchases.

Use popularity to select what to display as the top items.

Build an offline batching pipeline to process what's popular.

Potential Follow-Up Questions (optional):

- Build a **real time** data pipeline to process what's "hot" right now.
- Personalize

Solution Guidance: The candidate needs to clarify requirements and map what we do "on the web" to specific technologies.

For the basics, the candidate should **know** the major components listed below. (It's not an exhaustive list since the internet has many layers.)